

Scott Mather

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Freelance web developer who takes over neglected websites and makes them secure, stable, and editable by their owners. Builds the tool, measures the result, and translates the technical side for non-technical clients. Self-taught in machine learning and NLP through independent music-data research.

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Web Developer & Administrator — Remote, primarily healthcare clients Jan 2024 – Present

- Took over three medical-education properties (WordPress, a nine-site Multisite, and a Laravel app) from a departed vendor. Removed pirated software and vendor access, ended recurring crashes, and built security, backups, and monitoring from scratch with zero editor-facing breakage.
- FootEducation: Google Search clicks up 114% and impressions up 94% year over year after security, performance, and indexing fixes; site audit errors 449 to 0. Root-caused recurring crashes to PHP memory exhaustion and retuned the server.
- OrthoEducation: led a five-phase cleanup of the multisite network. Database 2.1 GB to 166 MB, files 5.5 GB to 2.8 GB, plugins 37 to 19, ~275 orphaned tables dropped. Search impressions up 33x over the following year.
- OrthoPaedia: wrote a WP-CLI tool that migrated a 266-page peer-reviewed textbook from Elementor to native Gutenberg blocks with zero failures, plus a verifier confirming every page matched before and after.
- Foot Pain Identifier: stabilized a crashing Laravel app holding 10,000+ patient responses. Wrote a custom fail2ban jail that bans credential-scanning bots on first probe, validated against 870+ hits in one day. Ended a contact-form spam flood with layered defenses and no added friction for patients.
- Built reusable tooling from this work: a network-wide sitemap and search mu-plugin (in production across nine sites) and a Playwright visual smoke-test runner that re-screenshots 27 key pages after every change.
- Kept the owner, a physician, informed with plain-language updates backed by server maps, session logs, and phased cleanup plans. Also migrated BayHealth LLC between hosts with no downtime and rebuilt it in Divi so the owners can edit it themselves.

Administrative Coordinator & Web Developer — Harmony Healing House, Bay Area, CA Oct 2022 – Present

- Built and maintain the organization's website, including the Health & Happiness Hub of Sonoma Valley, a regional health-resource directory that staff extend without developer help. Ran marketing through events, newsletters, and landing pages.

Research Assistant — UC Davis Department of Communication, Dr. Seth Frey Sep 2020 – Jan 2021

- Supported research on computational approaches to self-governance, studying how online communities and games organize themselves. Coded qualitative data into structured, machine-readable form.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

Basilect Engine Python · NLP · embeddings · recommender systems 2026

- Music similarity engine that connects artists by how they describe their creative process, using verbatim interview quotes instead of audio or listening data, to surface kinships that cross genre lines. Followed the problem into recommender-systems literature and the Music-CRS 2026 Codabench challenge, reaching baseline parity.
- Built the full pipeline (interview search, scraping, quote extraction, per-artist embedding aggregation, pairwise comparison) with corpus quality thresholds per artist. Compared Jaccard, Spearman, cosine, and count-adjusted similarity.

NTS Artist Map Python · web crawling · data engineering · network visualization 2026

- Same thesis, different signal: which artists radio curators play in the same hour. Crawled 86,600 NTS Radio episodes across 1,709 shows with zero errors, using the sitemap as the frontier where the public API cannot paginate.
- Canonicalized 1.5M free-text artist strings to artist IDs at 80.5% resolution; ranked 11M artist pairs by distinct curator count so no single show can fake a connection. Published an interactive network map of the results.

Phonetic Goblins vanilla JavaScript · linguistics 2026

- Generator of absurd character names from weighted phoneme pools and fake-etymology suffix families, with English junction rules that keep every output pronounceable. Live on GitHub Pages.

airplop Go (ported from Python/Flask) · networking 2026

- Browser-based AirDrop substitute from a Windows PC to iPhones on the LAN: real-time push over Server-Sent Events, mDNS so bookmarks never go stale, QR pairing, and scripted WSL2 port-forwarding that survives reboots.

EDUCATION

B.S. Cognitive Science, Computational Emphasis — University of California, Davis 2017 – 2021

Coursework: Computational Social Science, Linguistic Analysis, Statistical Analysis, Linear Algebra, Object-Oriented Programming

SKILLS

Web & servers: WordPress (Multisite, WP-CLI, mu-plugins, Divi), Laravel, PHP, Apache, MySQL, Linux administration, DigitalOcean, AWS, Cloudflare, Sucuri, fail2ban, Wix

Programming: Python, PHP, JavaScript/TypeScript, Go, Bash, SQL, HTML/CSS, Git, Playwright

Data & ML: text embeddings, NLP pipelines, web crawling, recommender systems, vector search (Pinecone), data visualization

SEO & analytics: Google Search Console, GA4, Semrush, Screaming Frog, Yoast

VOLUNTEER

Web Developer — Cancer Support Sonoma. Redesigned the nonprofit's site around how clients find services; maintain it. Ongoing

DJ & Volunteer — KDVS 90.3 FM, Davis. Hosted an on-air show; helped run fundraisers and small-venue concerts. 2018 – 2020